

TITLE: Acceptable Use Policy
ORGANIZATION: Northwind Analytics, Inc.
DEPARTMENT: IT
SENSITIVITY: Internal
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Acceptable Use Policy

This policy defines acceptable use of Northwind Analytics, Inc. devices, network, internet access, and software by all employees, contractors, and temporary staff.

1. General Principles

- Company systems are provided primarily for business purposes; limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work or violate other policies.
- Users are responsible for all activity under their credentials and must not share passwords.
- All activity on company networks and devices may be logged and monitored for security purposes.

2. Prohibited Activities

- Accessing, storing, or transmitting illegal, discriminatory, or offensive content.
- Installing unauthorized or unlicensed software on company devices.
- Circumventing security controls, including disabling endpoint protection or using unauthorized VPN/proxy tools.
- Using company email or systems for personal commercial activity or solicitation.
- Connecting personally-owned storage devices (USB drives, external HDDs) to manufacturing floor OT/SCADA systems without prior IT Security approval.

3. Internet and Email Use

Web filtering is applied at the network level to block known-malicious and non-business categories of content. Employees should report suspicious emails using the "Report Phishing" button rather than forwarding or replying to them.

4. Manufacturing OT Network

Operational Technology (OT) systems on the manufacturing floor are logically segmented from the corporate IT network. Access to OT systems is restricted to authorized Manufacturing Engineering and IT/OT Security personnel only; use of general-purpose laptops on the OT network requires a documented exception.

5. Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and may be reported to law enforcement where applicable law is violated.